

LAW ERP · CASE MANAGEMENT MODULE V2

Case Management — Field Guide

How everything works, what every field means, and how a real case flows — explained for lawyers, clients and developers, with the actual API calls

Package: `com.lawfirm.erp.modules.casemanagement` · **API base:** `/api/v1/firm`

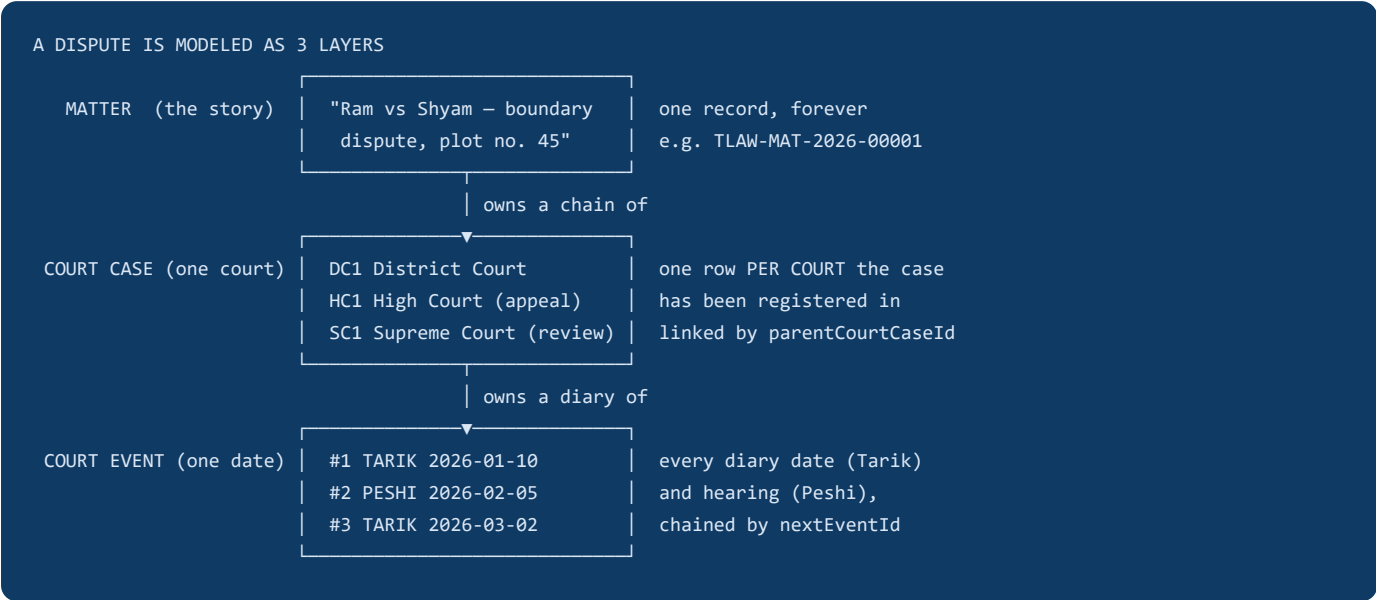
Auth: `Authorization: Bearer <JWT>` · Roles: FIRM_ADMIN / ADVOCATE / PARALEGAL

Three examples inside: a normal case · a case that appeals to another court · a long tarik → peshi → tarik → peshi chain



Part 1 · How it works (plain language)

Think of the system as a **three-level stack**. Every piece of a dispute is stored at exactly the level where it belongs, so nothing is ever duplicated and every screen can be traced back to the same source data.



1.1 Matter — the dispute

A **Matter** is the whole dispute as the firm tracks it: who is suing whom, what type of case it is (civil or criminal), which court it started in, and which partner owns it. It is created once and never re-created — everything that happens later attaches to it.

1.2 CourtCase — one row per court

When the dispute is **filed in a court** — first at District, then later on appeal at High Court, then possibly at Supreme Court — each registration is a separate **CourtCase**. They are linked in a chain (`parentCourtCaseId`), so the whole journey is visible: DC1 → HC1 → SC1, and even remands back down to DC2. Each CourtCase has its own stage, status, judge, advocate, and its own diary of events.

1.3 CourtEvent — the diary (Tarik & Peshi)

Every date the court gives is a **CourtEvent**. Nepali court practice has two kinds:

- **TARIK** (तारेख) — an **administrative date**: a formality, often handled by a junior or clerk. “Come back on this date.”
- **PESHI** (पेशी) — a **real hearing**: arguments, evidence, orders, judgment.

Events are numbered per court case (#1, #2, #3 ...) and **chained**: when today's event is marked “held”, the system asks “*what did the court give next?*” and creates the next event automatically — exactly like writing the next date in a lawyer's diary, but structured and impossible to lose.

1.4 Parties & roles

- **MatterParty** = who the person *is* (name, phone, email, address). Created once per dispute.
- **CourtCaseRole** = what role they play *in this particular court* (plaintiff/defendant/appellant...). Roles flip on appeal — the defendant who lost at District becomes the **appellant** at High Court.
- **Representation** = REPRESENTED (we act for them), OPPOSING (we act against them), SELF (self-represented).

1.5 Timeline & audit

Every meaningful action (matter created, event scheduled, event held, judgment recorded, appeal filed) writes an immutable **timeline entry**. The firm can show “everything that ever happened” per matter, or firm-wide as one feed. A separate audit log records who did what, when.

1.6 Judgment & appeal deadlines

When a judgment is recorded, the system immediately computes the **statutory appeal window** (e.g. 30 days for a civil appeal from District Court) from a seeded rule table and stores the *appeal deadline* on the case. A nightly job watches those deadlines; a watch-list endpoint tells the firm which cases' windows are closing soon, and cases where the window lapsed with no appeal are marked final and the matter is nudged to DORMANT. Missing an appeal window is often irreversible — this is a first-class feature on purpose.

Part 2 · What every field means

2.1 Matter fields

Field	What it means
<code>id / uuid</code>	Internal unique identifiers (UUID). Used by the API; humans use <code>matterNumber</code> .
<code>firmId</code>	Which law firm this matter belongs to (multi-tenant). Set from your login, never sent by you.
<code>matterNumber</code>	Generated, permanent reference: <code>{firmCode}-MAT-{year}-{seq}</code> , e.g. <code>TLAW-MAT-2026-00001</code> . This is the ID you use in URLs.
<code>matterType</code>	<code>CIVIL</code> or <code>CRIMINAL</code> . Decides the stage machine the case follows.
<code>title</code>	Short human name of the dispute, e.g. "Ram vs Shyam — boundary dispute".
<code>status</code>	<code>ACTIVE</code> (work happening) · <code>DORMANT</code> (nothing pending — e.g. appeal window lapsed) · <code>CLOSED</code> (done).
<code>currentCourtCaseId</code>	Points at the current leaf in the court-case chain — the one the UI should open by default.
<code>assignedPartnerId</code>	The partner at the firm who owns the matter.
<code>originatingCourtLevel</code>	Where the dispute started: <code>DISTRICT</code> / <code>HIGH</code> / <code>SUPREME</code> / <code>SPECIALIZED</code> .
<code>description</code>	Free-text notes about the dispute.
<code>createdAt / updatedAt</code>	When the record was created / last changed.

2.2 CourtCase fields

Field	What it means
<code>matterId</code>	Which dispute this court instance belongs to.
<code>parentCourtCaseId</code>	The court case this one <i>came from</i> (e.g. the District case that was appealed). Null for the very first case.
<code>relationType</code>	How this instance relates to its parent: <code>ORIGINAL</code> (first filing) · <code>APPEAL</code> · <code>CROSS_APPEAL</code> · <code>REMAND</code> (sent back) · <code>REVISION</code> · <code>WRIT</code> (constitutional petition filed at HC/SC) · <code>REVIEW</code> (re-opening a final judgment at SC).
<code>courtLevel</code>	<code>DISTRICT</code> / <code>HIGH</code> / <code>SUPREME</code> / <code>SPECIALIZED</code> .
<code>courtName</code>	Display name, e.g. "High Court, Patan".
<code>courtCaseNumber</code>	The court's own official registration number . May be empty until the registry assigns it — the internal <code>ourCourtCaseRef</code> is always available.
<code>ourCourtCaseRef</code>	Generated internal reference: <code>{matterNumber}-{level}{n}</code> — <code>DC1</code> , <code>HC1</code> , <code>SC1</code> , <code>DC2</code> after a remand. Always populated; used in URLs.
<code>filingDate</code>	Date the case was filed at this court.
<code>stage</code>	Where in the court process this instance sits (see the stage machine in Part 3).

status	ACTIVE · JUDGMENT_AWAITED · DECIDED · APPEALED · REMANDED · CLOSED · WITHDRAWN .
advocateId	Which advocate is handling <i>this instance</i> (often a senior counsel is briefed for the appeal).
judgeName	Presiding judge (free text).
judgmentDate	Date the judgment was delivered.
judgmentSummary	Short summary of the decision.
decisionInFavorOfPartyId	Which party (MatterParty id) the decision favored.
appealDeadline	Computed automatically when the judgment is recorded, from the statutory rule table (e.g. 30 days for District civil).
partyIsState	Whether a state/government party is involved — widens some appeal windows (e.g. criminal 70 days instead of 30). Recorded once at creation; the deadline engine always trusts the stored value.
appealRequiresLeave	True for High Court judgments : a further appeal to the Supreme Court needs a <i>leave petition</i> first — not an automatic appeal.
appealLapsed	Set by the nightly watcher when the appeal window expired with no appeal filed and no child case. The judgment is final.
Criminal trial fields: firNumber (FIR registration no.) · firDate · policeStation · investigationAuthority · arrestDate · chargeSheetDate · bailStatus (GRANTED / DENIED / PENDING).	
Civil trial fields: mediationDate · mediationOutcome · writtenStatementDeadline .	
roles[]	Party roles in <i>this</i> court instance (see 2.4).
eventCount	Number of diary events on this case so far.

2.3 CourtEvent fields (Tarik/Peshi)

Field	What it means
courtCaseId	Which court case this date belongs to.
eventType	TARIK administrative date · PESHI real hearing.
sequenceNo	Order within the court case: #1, #2, #3...
scheduledDate	The date the court gave.
scheduledTime / endTime	Optional start/end time — used for advocate conflict detection.
status	SCHEDULED (upcoming) · HELD (it happened) · ADJOURNED (no progress) · CANCELED .
outcome	Free text — what happened on the day.
outcomeType	Structured outcome (see enum table in 2.6) — drives side-effects.
nextEventType	What the court gave next: TARIK / PESHI / JUDGMENT / NONE (closed).
nextEventId	Link to the next event the system created — renders the chain.
attendingAdvocateId	Which advocate is appearing (conflict-checked across the firm).
judgeName / courtRoom	Who presides and where.
conflictWarning	Response-only: set when a Tarik was allowed despite an advocate overlap (Peshi would have been blocked).

2.4 Party fields

Field	What it means
fullName / mobileNo / email / address	Contact/identity of the person. Identity lives on MatterParty .
clientId	Optional link to an existing client profile (from the client module).
isOurClient	Is this person one of the firm's clients.
roleType	Role in this court instance: PLAINTIFF , DEFENDANT , ACCUSED , APPELLANT , RESPONDENT , APPLICANT , COMPLAINANT (state/complainant side), INFORMANT (person who lodged the FIR).
representation	REPRESENTED (we act for them) · OPPOSING (we act against them) · SELF .
advocateId	Advocate representing <i>this party</i> in <i>this</i> court instance.

2.5 Timeline event fields

Field	What it means
matterId / courtCaseId	What the event belongs to (courtCaseId is null for matter-level events like creation).
eventType	The kind of event (see enum table).
title / description	Human-readable summary ("Event held: ...-DC1 #3") and details.
createdAt / createdBy	When it happened and which user did it.

2.6 Enum cheat-sheet — every value, in plain words

Enum	Value	Plain meaning
MatterType	CIVIL	Property, contract, family, money disputes...
	CRIMINAL	State prosecution / crime
MatterStatus	ACTIVE	Something is happening
	DORMANT	No pending work (e.g. appeal window lapsed)
	CLOSED	Finished
CourtLevel	DISTRICT	District Court (trial)
	HIGH	High Court (appeals)
	SUPREME	Supreme Court (final appeals, review)
	SPECIALIZED	Specialized tribunals/courts
RelationType	ORIGINAL	First registration of the dispute
	APPEAL	A party appeals the decision
	CROSS_APPEAL	The other side also appeals
	REMAND	Higher court sends it back to a lower court
	REVISION	Higher court re-examines legality of the decision

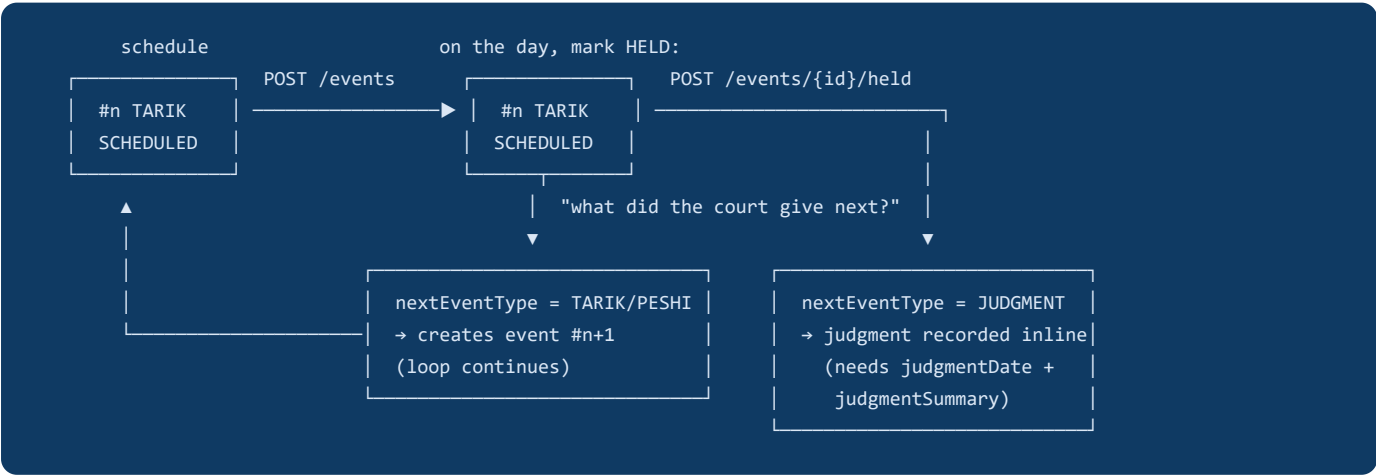
	WRIT	Constitutional petition filed directly at HC/SC (never at District)	
	REVIEW	SC re-opens a judgment that has gone final (parent stays untouched)	
CourtEventType	TARIK	Administrative date (formal “come back on this date”)	
	PESHI	Real hearing (arguments, evidence, orders, judgment)	
CourtEventStatus	SCHEDULED	Upcoming	
	HELD	It happened	
	ADJOURNED	Happened but no progress (adjourned)	
	CANCELED	Removed from the diary	
OutcomeType	PART_HEARD	Hearing started, continues next time	
	ARGUMENTS_COMPLETE	Both sides finished arguing	
	EVIDENCE_TAKEN	Witnesses/exhibits heard	
	ADJOURNED_NO_PROGRESS	Adjourned, nothing achieved	
	ORDER_PASSED	An order was passed	
	ORDER_ISSUED	An order was issued (writ context)	
	STAY_GRANTED	Stay/stay-order granted	
	INTERIM_ORDER	Interim relief ordered	
	JUDGMENT_DELIVERED	The judgment was delivered — requires judgment fields inline	
	WITHDRAWN	Case withdrawn	
NextEventType	TARIK	Court gave an administrative next date	
	PESHI	Court gave a next hearing	
	JUDGMENT	Court reserved judgment (no event row — record it when delivered)	
	NONE	Case closed at this event	
PartyType	PLAINTIFF / DEFENDANT	Civil sides at trial	
	ACCUSED	Criminal defendant	
	APPELLANT / RESPONDENT	Sides on appeal (roles flip!)	
	APPLICANT	Writ/petition filer	
	COMPLAINANT	State/complainant side in criminal matters	
	INFORMANT	The person who lodged the FIR	
	PartyRepresentation	REPRESENTED	The firm acts for this party
		OPPOSING	The firm acts against this party

SELF		Self-represented	
BailStatus	GRANTED / DENIED / PENDING	Bail posture of the accused	
	CourtCaseStatus	ACTIVE	In progress
		JUDGMENT_AWAITED	Arguments done, judgment pending
DECIDED		Judgment delivered (always has judgment fields + deadline)	
APPEALED		A child appeal was filed	
REMANDED		Sent back by a higher court	
CLOSED		Terminal	
WITHDRAWN		Party withdrew	
TimelineEventType	MATTER_CREATED	The dispute was created	
	COURT_CASE_ADDED	A new court instance was added	
	STAGE_CHANGE	The case moved to another stage	
	MEDIATION_FAILED / MEDIATION_SUCCEEDED	Mediation outcome	
	COURT_EVENT_SCHEDULED / HELD / ADJOURNED / CANCELLED	Diary lifecycle	
	PARTY_ADDED	A party joined the matter	
	JUDGMENT_RECORDED	Judgment + appeal deadline recorded	
	APPEAL_FILED	An appeal-type case was added	
	MATTER_NOTE_ADDED	Matter details updated	

Part 3 · How a case flows (the machinery)

3.1 The Tarik/Peshi diary loop

This is the heart of the system — the digital equivalent of writing the next date in the diary.



- **Schedule:** `POST /court-cases/{ref}/events` with the type, date, time, advocate. A firm-wide advocate-overlap check runs: **Peshi conflicts are blocked (400); Tarik conflicts are allowed** with a `conflictWarning` on the response (they are often handled by a clerk).
- **Mark held:** `POST /court-events/{id}/held` requires the answer to “what did the court give next?”: `TARIK / PESHI` → the server creates the next event and links it via `nextEventId`; `JUDGMENT` → no event row (judgment gets recorded when delivered — inline in this same call); `NONE` → the case is closed at this event.
- **Judgment inline:** if the outcome was `JUDGMENT_DELIVERED`, the call **must** also carry `judgmentDate` and `judgmentSummary` — a case can only become `DECIDED` with the judgment on record (this is enforced so the two judgment paths can never drift apart).

3.2 Stage machine

Each court case has a **stage** chosen from a state machine that knows which stages are legal for the combination of court level × matter type × relation type. The server validates every transition; the UI never needs to duplicate the machine — it asks `GET /court-cases/{ref}/allowed-stages` for the legal next moves.

```

CIVIL (District trial)          CRIMINAL (District trial)
FILED → SUMMONS_ISSUED          FIR_REGISTERED → UNDER_INVESTIGATION
→ RESPONSE_PENDING              → CHARGE_SHEET_FILED
→ MEDIATION → HEARING_STAGE    → HEARING_STAGE
    ↳ settlement → CLOSED
HEARING_STAGE → JUDGMENT_AWAITED → JUDGMENT_DELIVERED
    → (APPEALED / FURTHER_APPEALED / REMANDED / EXECUTION / SENTENCING / CLOSED)

APPEAL (High / Supreme / Specialized)  WRIT (direct HC/SC filing)
APPEAL_FILED → ADMITTED → HEARING_STAGE  WRIT_FILED → ADMITTED → HEARING_STAGE
    ↳ NOTICE_ISSUED → HEARING_STAGE      ↳ ORDER_ISSUED → CLOSED
... → JUDGMENT_AWAITED → JUDGMENT_DELIVERED → ...
CLOSED is the only terminal stage.
  
```

Stages vs statuses. `stage` is the procedural position (fine-grained); `status` is the coarse state used by dashboards. They move together: entering `JUDGMENT_AWAITED` sets `status JUDGMENT_AWAITED`, entering `JUDGMENT_DELIVERED` sets `DECIDED`, entering `EXECUTION` sets `ACTIVE` (and clears `appealLapsed`), entering `CLOSED` sets `CLOSED`.

3.3 Judgment & the appeal-deadline engine

Recording a judgment (`PUT /court-cases/{ref}/judgment`, or inline on a held event) does five things in one transaction:

1. Sets `judgmentDate`, `judgmentSummary`, `decisionInFavorOfPartyId`;
2. Moves stage → `JUDGMENT_DELIVERED` and status → `DECIDED`;
3. Computes `appealDeadline` from the seeded statutory rules;
4. Sets `appealRequiresLeave=true` for High Court judgments (SC appeal = leave petition);
5. Writes a `JUDGMENT_RECORDED` timeline entry + audit log.

Appealed from	Type	State party	Window	Extension	Leave needed?
District	Civil	—	30 days	+15	No
District	Criminal	Yes	70 days	+30	No
District	Criminal	No	30 days	+30	No
High	Civil	—	35 days	+15	Yes
High	Criminal	—	35 days	+30	Yes
High	Criminal	Yes	70 days	+30	Yes

The **watch list** (`GET /court-cases/appeal-deadlines?withinDays=30`) lists every decided, not-lapsed case whose window closes within N days and no appeal has been filed yet. A nightly job (03:00) marks lapsed cases `appealLapsed=true` and nudges the matter to `DORMANT`.

GET /matters/stale is the companion flag: matters whose current leaf hasn't had a real Peshi in N days.

3.4 The appeal chain (going to another court)

To appeal: POST /matters/{matterNumber}/court-cases with relationType=APPEAL , the new level, court name, and the roles on the new instance. The system:

- Creates the child case (ref HC1), initial stage APPEAL_FILED ;
- Marks the parent APPEALED (or REMANDED for a remand) — **except REVIEW**, which leaves the parent untouched;
- Moves the matter's currentCourtCaseId leaf to the child and sets the matter back to ACTIVE;
- Rejects attaching a new proceeding to a **closed** parent (again, REVIEW is the one exception — it is filed *after* the judgment is final).

Part 4 · Three worked examples — business flow + the exact API calls

How to read the examples. For each example there is (1) a **business flow table** — the human story, dates and all — and (2) the **API level**: the exact requests and the important parts of the responses. Firm code TLAW ; all IDs abbreviated (...). Bodies are wrapped in { "data": ... } ; auth header Authorization: Bearer <JWT> is assumed on every call.

Example A — a normal case that runs its course (civil, District Court, no appeal)

The business story

On 1 Aug 2026 Ram Sharma sues Shyam Thapa at Kathmandu District Court over a boundary dispute (plot no. 45). The court issues summons; Shyam files a written response; mediation fails; two hearings happen; arguments close; judgment is delivered on 28 Oct in Ram's favour. The 30-day appeal window passes with no appeal, so the matter settles into DORMANT. One matter, one court case, six diary events.

#	Date	Business event	System record
1	01-Aug	Firm files the case at District Court	Matter created + CourtCase DC1 (stage FILED)
2	15-Aug	Court gives a Tarik (administrative date)	Event #1 TARIK scheduled
3	15-Aug	On the Tarik, court issues summons & gives next date	Event #1 HELD → next event #2 created (stage SUMMONS_ISSUED)
4	02-Sep	Peshi: Shyam's response submitted	Event #2 PESHI HELD → next created (stage RESPONSE_PENDING)
5	10-Sep	Mediation day — fails	Event #3 PESHI HELD, outcome ADJOURNED_NO_PROGRESS (stage MEDIATION → HEARING_STAGE)
6	22-Sep	Peshi: plaintiff evidence	Event #4 PESHI HELD → next created
7	06-Oct	Peshi: arguments complete	Event #5 PESHI HELD, outcome ARGUMENTS_COMPLETE, next = JUDGMENT (stage HEARING_STAGE → JUDGMENT_AWAITED)
8	28-Oct	Judgment delivered in Ram's favour	Stage JUDGMENT_DELIVERED, status DECIDED, appealDeadline = 27-Nov (30 days)
9	after 27-Nov	No appeal filed — window lapsed	Nightly watcher: appealLapsed=true, matter → DORMANT

API level — step by step

POST /api/v1/firm/matters - create the matter + original court case + parties

```
{ "data": {
  "matterType": "CIVIL",
  "title": "Ram Sharma vs Shyam Thapa – boundary dispute, plot no. 45",
  "originatingCourtLevel": "DISTRICT",
  "courtName": "Kathmandu District Court",
  "courtCaseNumber": "C-123/082",
  "filingDate": "2026-08-01",
  "advocateId": "...adv-1...",
  "description": "Boundary dispute over plot no. 45",
  "parties": [
    { "fullName": "Ram Sharma", "mobileNo": "9800000001", "email": "ram@mail.com",
      "isOurClient": true, "roleType": "PLAINTIFF", "representation": "REPRESENTED" },
    { "fullName": "Shyam Thapa", "mobileNo": "9800000002",
      "roleType": "DEFENDANT", "representation": "OPPOSING" }
  ]
} }
```

```
// Response (abridged) – SAVE matterNumber and ourCourtCaseRef
{ "success": true, "responseCode": 200, "message": "Matter created successfully",
  "data": {
    "matterNumber": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00001", "matterType": "CIVIL", "status": "ACTIVE",
    "currentCourtCaseId": "...cc-1...",
    "courtCases": [ { "id": "...cc-1...", "ourCourtCaseRef": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00001-DC1",
      "relationType": "ORIGINAL", "courtLevel": "DISTRICT",
      "stage": "FILED", "status": "ACTIVE",
      "roles": [ { "fullName": "Ram Sharma", "roleType": "PLAINTIFF", "representation": "REPRESENTED" },
        { "fullName": "Shyam Thapa", "roleType": "DEFENDANT", "representation": "OPPOSING" } ]
    } ],
    "parties": [ { "fullName": "Ram Sharma", "isOurClient": true }, { "fullName": "Shyam Thapa" } ]
  } }
```

POST

/api/v1/firm/court-cases/TLAW-MAT-2026-00001-DC1 – schedule Tarik #1

```
{ "data": { "eventType": "TARIK", "scheduledDate": "2026-08-15",
  "scheduledTime": "10:00:00", "attendingAdvocateId": "...adv-1..." } }

→ { "success": true, "data": { "id": "...ev-1...", "sequenceNo": 1, "eventType": "TARIK",
  "scheduledDate": "2026-08-15", "status": "SCHEDULED" } } }
```

POST

/api/v1/firm/court-events/ev-1/hold – Tarik happened; court gave next date

```
{ "data": { "outcome": "Summons issued to defendant", "outcomeType": "ORDER_PASSED",
  "nextEventType": "PESHI", "nextEventDate": "2026-09-02", "nextEventTime": "11:00:00" } }

→ { "success": true, "data": { "id": "...ev-1...", "status": "HELD", "nextEventType": "PESHI",
  "nextEventId": "...ev-2..." } } // the server created event #2 for 02-Sep automatically
```

PUT

/api/v1/firm/court-cases/TLAW-MAT-2026-00001-DC1/stage – summons out

```
{ "data": { "stage": "SUMMONS_ISSUED" } } // validated: FILED → SUMMONS_ISSUED is legal
```

POST

/api/v1/firm/court-events/ev-2/hold – Peshi: response submitted

```
{ "data": { "outcome": "Written statement filed by defendant", "outcomeType": "PART_HEARD",
  "nextEventType": "PESHI", "nextEventDate": "2026-09-10" } }

// then stage → RESPONSE_PENDING → MEDIATION (stage endpoint, legal transitions)
```

POST

api/v1/firm/court-cases/evnts/evnt3 - mediation day, failed

```
{ "data": { "outcome": "No settlement possible", "outcomeType": "ADJOURNED_NO_PROGRESS",
            "nextEventType": "PESHI", "nextEventDate": "2026-09-22" } }
// event #3 → ADJOURNED, event #4 auto-created. Stage MEDIATION → HEARING_STAGE logs MEDIATION_FAILED.
```

POST

api/v1/firm/court-cases/evnts/evnt5 - arguments complete; judgment reserved

```
{ "data": { "outcome": "Both sides argued fully", "outcomeType": "ARGUMENTS_COMPLETE",
            "nextEventType": "JUDGMENT" } } // no next date given – judgment will be recorded when delivered
// stage → JUDGMENT_AWAITED (status JUDGMENT_AWAITED)
```

PUT

api/v1/firm/court-cases/TLAW-MAT-2026-00001-DC1/judgment - judgment delivered

```
{ "data": { "judgmentDate": "2026-10-28",
            "judgmentSummary": "Boundary fixed in favour of the plaintiff per survey plan",
            "decisionInFavorOfPartyId": "...matter-party-Ram..." } }

→ { "success": true, "data": { "ourCourtCaseRef": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00001-DC1",
    "stage": "JUDGMENT_DELIVERED", "status": "DECIDED",
    "appealDeadline": "2026-11-27", "appealRequiresLeave": false, "appealLapsed": false } }
```

GET

api/v1/firm/court-cases/appeal-deadlines/watchlist - the watch list sees it

```
→ { "success": true, "data": [ { "ourCourtCaseRef": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00001-DC1",
    "courtLevel": "DISTRICT", "judgmentDate": "2026-10-28", "appealDeadline": "2026-11-27",
    "partyIsState": false, "appealRequiresLeave": false,
    "matterNumber": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00001", "matterTitle": "Ram Sharma vs Shyam Thapa..." } ] }
```

End of Example A. Nobody appeals. After 27-Nov the nightly watcher sets `appealLapsed=true` on DC1 and the matter becomes DORMANT. The full history is visible via `GET /matters/TLAW-MAT-2026-00001 (chain)` and `GET /matters/TLAW-MAT-2026-00001/timeline`.

Example B — a case that goes to another court on appeal (District → High Court)

The business story

Building on Example A: Shyam loses at District Court and instructs the firm to appeal to the High Court, Patan, within the 30-day window (filed 10 Nov). At High Court the roles flip — Shyam is now the **appellant**, Ram the **respondent**. The appeal is admitted, notices issue, hearings run, and on 15 Mar 2027 the High Court delivers judgment. Because it is a High Court judgment, a further appeal to the Supreme Court is a *leave petition* process: the deadline is 35 days (19 Apr 2027) and `appealRequiresLeave=true`.

#	Date	Business event	System record
1	28-Oct-2026	District judgment for Ram; 30-day window opens	DC1 DECIDED, appealDeadline 27-Nov
2	10-Nov-2026	Firm files appeal at High Court, Patan	New CourtCase HC1 (APPEAL), parent DC1 → APPEALED, matter leaf → HC1
3	05-Dec-2026	Appeal admitted; notices issued	HC1 stage APPEAL_FILED → ADMITTED → NOTICE_ISSUED
4	Jan–Feb 2027	Hearings at High Court	Peshi events; stage HEARING_STAGE

5	15-Mar-2027	High Court judgment (Shyam's appeal succeeds in part)	HC1 JUDGMENT_DELIVERED / DECIDED; deadline 19-Apr (35d), appealRequiresLeave=true
6	Apr-2027	Firm considers leave petition to Supreme Court	Watch list flags HC1 — leave petition required

API level — step by step

GET

/api/v1/firm/court-cases/appeal-deadlines?withinDays=30

– deadline looming (before filing)

```
→ { "success": true, "data": [ { "ourCourtCaseRef": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00001-DC1",
    "appealDeadline": "2026-11-27", "appealRequiresLeave": false, ... } ] }
```

POST

/api/v1/firm/matters/TLAW-MAT-2026-00001/court-cases

– file the appeal

```
{ "data": {
  "relationType": "APPEAL",
  "courtLevel": "HIGH",
  "courtName": "High Court, Patan",
  "courtCaseNumber": "HC-555/083",
  "filingDate": "2026-11-10",
  "advocateId": "...adv-senior...",
  "judgeName": "Justice A. Poudel",
  "parentCourtCaseId": "...cc-DC1...", // optional – defaults to the current leaf
  "partyIsState": false,
  "roles": [ // roles FLIP: defendant becomes appellant
    { "matterPartyId": "...matter-party-Shyam...", "roleType": "APPELLANT", "representation": "REPRESENTED" },
    { "matterPartyId": "...matter-party-Ram...", "roleType": "RESPONDENT", "representation": "OPPOSING" }
  ]
}
```

```
→ { "success": true, "data": { "matterNumber": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00001",
  "currentCourtCaseId": "...cc-HC1...",
  "courtCases": [
    { "ourCourtCaseRef": "...-DC1", "status": "APPEALED", "stage": "APPEALED" }, // parent superseded
    { "ourCourtCaseRef": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00001-HC1", "relationType": "APPEAL",
      "courtLevel": "HIGH", "stage": "APPEAL_FILED", "status": "ACTIVE",
      "roles": [ { "fullName": "Shyam Thapa", "roleType": "APPELLANT", "representation": "REPRESENTED" },
        { "fullName": "Ram Sharma", "roleType": "RESPONDENT", "representation": "OPPOSING" } ] }
  ]
}
```

PUT

/api/v1/firm/court-cases/TLAW-MAT-2026-00001-HC1

– admitted, then notices issued

```
{ "data": { "stage": "ADMITTED" } } // APPEAL_FILED → ADMITTED legal
{ "data": { "stage": "NOTICE_ISSUED" } } // ADMITTED → NOTICE_ISSUED legal
{ "data": { "stage": "HEARING_STAGE" } } // NOTICE_ISSUED → HEARING_STAGE legal
// (the UI can also call GET /court-cases/...HC1/allowed-stages at each step to render the dropdown)
```

POST

/api/v1/firm/court-cases/TLAW-MAT-2026-00001-HC1/events

+ /heId

– the hearings (same loop as Example A)

```
{ "data": { "eventType": "PESHI", "scheduledDate": "2027-01-20", "scheduledTime": "10:30:00",
  "endTime": "11:30:00", "attendingAdvocateId": "...adv-senior...", "courtRoom": "Court 5" } }
→ { "success": true, "data": { "sequenceNo": 1, "status": "SCHEDULED" } }
// ... on the day:
{ "data": { "outcome": "Heard in part", "outcomeType": "PART_HEARD",
  "nextEventType": "PESHI", "nextEventDate": "2027-02-10" } }
```

PUT

api/v1/Firm/court-cases/TLAW-MAT-2026-00001-HC1/judgment

– High Court decides

```
{ "data": { "judgmentDate": "2027-03-15",
            "judgmentSummary": "Appeal partly allowed – boundary re-fixed; costs to appellant" } }

→ { "success": true, "data": { "stage": "JUDGMENT_DELIVERED", "status": "DECIDED",
    "appealDeadline": "2027-04-19",           // 35 days
    "appealRequiresLeave": true,               // High Court → SC needs a LEAVE PETITION
    "appealLapsed": false } }
```

GET

api/v1/Firm/court-cases/TLAW-MAT-2026-00001-HC1

– HC1 now on the watch list

```
→ { "success": true, "data": [ { "ourCourtCaseRef": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00001-HC1",
    "courtLevel": "HIGH", "appealDeadline": "2027-04-19",
    "appealRequiresLeave": true, ... } ] }

// "requiresLeave: true" tells the UI to present this as a leave petition, not a plain appeal.
```

End of Example B. If the firm then files a REVIEW at the Supreme Court, it calls the same `POST /matters/.../court-cases` with `relationType=REVIEW`, `courtLevel=SUPREME` — HC1 is left untouched (a review lives on a final judgment by design), and the chain becomes DC1 → HC1 → SC1.

Example C — a long-pending case: tarik → peshi → tarik → peshi → tarik → peshi

The business story

A criminal matter (theft charge) at District Court keeps getting pushed: the court gives a Tarik, the Tarik rolls into a Peshi, the Peshi gets adjourned, another Tarik, another Peshi... months go by with no real progress. This is exactly the pattern the system is built to make visible: the **chained events** show the diary, and the **stale-matters** endpoint flags it when no real Peshi has happened for 90 days.

#	Date	Business event	System record
1	10-Jan-2026	Case registered (FIR) at District Court	Matter + DC1, stage FIR_REGISTERED
2	10-Jan	Court: “come back 05-Feb” (Tarik)	Event #1 TARIK (10-Jan)
3	05-Feb	Tarik held; court gives Peshi 02-Mar	#1 HELD → #2 PESHI (05-Feb)
4	02-Mar	Peshi; defence asks for time; adjourned	#2 HELD (ADJOURNED_NO_PROGRESS) → #3 TARIK (30-Mar)
5	30-Mar	Tarik; court gives Peshi 04-May	#3 HELD → #4 PESHI (04-May)
6	04-May	Peshi; witness not produced; next Tarik	#4 HELD (PART_HEARD) → #5 TARIK (01-Jun)
7	01-Jun	Tarik; court gives Peshi 06-Jul	#5 HELD → #6 PESHI (06-Jul)
8	06-Jul	Peshi — real hearing at last	#6 HELD, stage → HEARING_STAGE, #7 scheduled...

API level — step by step (the loop in action)

POST

api/v1/Firm/matters

– create the criminal matter

```
{ "data": { "matterType": "CRIMINAL", "title": "State vs Hari Bahadur – theft, FIR 42",
  "originatingCourtLevel": "DISTRICT", "courtName": "Kathmandu District Court",
  "courtCaseNumber": "CT-77/082", "filingDate": "2026-01-10",
  "parties": [
    { "fullName": "Hari Bahadur", "roleType": "ACCUSED", "representation": "REPRESENTED" },
    { "fullName": "Nepal Government", "roleType": "COMPLAINANT", "representation": "OPPOSING" }
  ] } }

→ "matterNumber": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00003", courtCases: [ { "ourCourtCaseRef": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00003-DC1",
  "stage": "FIR_REGISTERED", ... } ]
```

POST

/api/v1/firm/court-cases/TLAW-MAT-2026-00003-DC1/events – Tarik #1

```
{ "data": { "eventType": "TARIK", "scheduledDate": "2026-01-10",
  "attendingAdvocateId": "...adv-1..." } }
→ { "success": true, "data": { "id": "...ev-1...", "sequenceNo": 1, "eventType": "TARIK", "status": "SCHEDULED" } }
```

POST

/api/v1/firm/court-events/...ev-1/held – Tarik held → next is a Peshi

```
{ "data": { "outcome": "Matter called; next date fixed", "outcomeType": "ORDER_PASSED",
  "nextEventType": "PESHI", "nextEventDate": "2026-02-05", "nextEventTime": "11:00:00" } }
→ { "success": true, "data": { "id": "...ev-1...", "status": "HELD",
  "nextEventId": "...ev-2..." } } // event #2 (PESHI 05-Feb) auto-created
```

POST

/api/v1/firm/court-events/...ev-2/adj – Peshi adjourned, no progress → Tarik

```
{ "data": { "outcome": "Defence sought time to produce witnesses", "outcomeType": "ADJOURNED_NO_PROGRESS",
  "nextEventType": "TARIK", "nextEventDate": "2026-03-30" } }
→ { "success": true, "data": { "id": "...ev-2...", "status": "ADJOURNED", "nextEventId": "...ev-3..." } }
```

POST

/api/v1/firm/court-events/...ev-3/held – Tarik → Peshi, ... and so on

```
{ "data": { "outcome": "...", "outcomeType": "ORDER_PASSED",
  "nextEventType": "PESHI", "nextEventDate": "2026-05-04" } }
// ... the pattern repeats: each /held creates the next row.
// Eventually a real hearing happens:
{ "data": { "outcome": "Examination of witnesses began", "outcomeType": "EVIDENCE_TAKEN",
  "nextEventType": "PESHI", "nextEventDate": "2026-08-10" } }
```

GET

/api/v1/firm/court-cases/TLAW-MAT-2026-00003-DC1/events – the full chained diary

```
→ { "success": true, "data": [
  { "sequenceNo": 1, "eventType": "TARIK", "scheduledDate": "2026-01-10", "status": "HELD", "nextEventId": "...ev-2..." },
  { "sequenceNo": 2, "eventType": "PESHI", "scheduledDate": "2026-02-05", "status": "HELD", "nextEventId": "...ev-3..." },
  { "sequenceNo": 3, "eventType": "TARIK", "scheduledDate": "2026-03-30", "status": "HELD", "nextEventId": "...ev-4..." },
  { "sequenceNo": 4, "eventType": "PESHI", "scheduledDate": "2026-05-04", "status": "HELD", "nextEventId": "...ev-5..." },
  { "sequenceNo": 5, "eventType": "TARIK", "scheduledDate": "2026-06-01", "status": "HELD", "nextEventId": "...ev-6..." },
  { "sequenceNo": 6, "eventType": "PESHI", "scheduledDate": "2026-07-06", "status": "HELD", "outcomeType": "EVIDENCE_TAKEN", "nextEventId": "...ev-7..." },
  { "sequenceNo": 7, "eventType": "PESHI", "scheduledDate": "2026-08-10", "status": "SCHEDULED" }
] } // the frontend renders this chain from sequenceNo + nextEventId
```

GET

`/api/v1/firm/matters?days=90`

– the system flags long-pending chains

```
→ { "success": true, "data": { "content": [ { "matterNumber": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00003",
  "title": "State vs Hari Bahadur – theft, FIR 42", "matterType": "CRIMINAL", "status": "ACTIVE",
  "currentCourtCaseRef": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00003-DC1",
  "daysSinceLastPeshi": 41 } ], ... } }
// "daysSinceLastPeshi" is null when the matter has never had a real Peshi –
// it only counts non-cancelled PESHI events, so pure Tarik chains get flagged.
```

GET

`/api/v1/firm/matters?matterType=CRIMINAL&status=ACTIVE`

– the activity feed

```
→ { "success": true, "data": { "content": [
  { "eventType": "COURT_EVENT_HELD", "title": "Event held: TLAW-MAT-2026-00003-DC1 #6",
    "matterNumber": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00003", "matterTitle": "State vs Hari Bahadur...",
    "ourCourtCaseRef": "TLAW-MAT-2026-00003-DC1", "createdAt": "2026-07-06T13:40:00" }, ... ] } }
```

End of Example C. The same loop also shows up on the calendar (`GET /calendar?from=2026-08-01&to=2026-08-31` for the month view, `GET /calendar/today` for the day view) — the calendar is just a read-only projection of the same Tarik/Peshi events.

Part 5 • API cheat-sheet

Method	Path (under <code>/api/v1/firm</code>)	What it does
POST	<code>/matters</code>	Create matter + original court case + parties
GET	<code>/matters?matterType=&status=&search=</code>	List matters
GET	<code>/matters/{matterNumber}</code>	Matter detail — full chain + roles + parties
PUT	<code>/matters/{matterNumber}</code>	Update matter (title/description/partner/status)
GET	<code>/matters/{matterNumber}/timeline</code>	One matter's history
GET	<code>/matters/timeline?matterType=&status=&from=&to=</code>	Firm-wide activity feed
GET	<code>/matters/stale?days=90</code>	Matters with no real Peshi in N days
POST	<code>/matters/{matterNumber}/court-cases</code>	File appeal / remand / writ / review
POST	<code>/matters/{matterNumber}/parties</code>	Add a party
POST	<code>/matters/parties/match</code>	Dedup a party against clients/matter parties
GET	<code>/court-cases/{ourCourtCaseRef}</code>	Court case detail
PUT	<code>/court-cases/{ourCourtCaseRef}</code>	Update case fields (incl. criminal/civil fields)
PUT	<code>/court-cases/{ourCourtCaseRef}/stage</code>	Change stage (validated)
PUT	<code>/court-cases/{ourCourtCaseRef}/judgment</code>	Record judgment + compute appeal deadline
GET	<code>/court-cases/{ourCourtCaseRef}/allowed-stages</code>	Legal next stages for the dropdown
GET	<code>/court-cases/appeal-deadlines?withinDays=30</code>	Appeal-deadline watch list
POST	<code>/court-cases/{ourCourtCaseRef}/events</code>	Schedule a Tarik/Peshi
GET	<code>/court-cases/{ourCourtCaseRef}/events</code>	Event stream (the chained diary)

GET/PUT/DELETE	/court-events/{eventId}	Detail / update / cancel
POST	/court-events/{eventId}/held	Mark held → outcome + create next event
GET	/calendar?from=&to=&advocateId=	Calendar for a date range
GET	/calendar/today · /calendar/upcoming?days=7	Today / next N days

Case Management Field Guide — generated from the implementation in `com.lawfirm.erp.modules.casemanagement` · API base `/api/v1/firm` · Swagger UI at `/swagger-ui.html` · Companion doc: `docs/case-management-module.html` (design & API reference).